

## Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3219

**Name**

Sarah Busslinger

**Email**[sarah.busslinger@swissonline.ch](mailto:sarah.busslinger@swissonline.ch)**Gender**

Female

**City, state, and country of residence**

Baden, Aargau, Switzerland

**Nationality**

Swiss

**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

September 2023

**University Education**

Ph.D.: Pharmaceutical Sciences

ETH Zurich, Switzerland (work conducted at the Paul Scherrer Institute, Villigen-PSI, Switzerland)

2020 - Current (expected graduation date September 2023)

Master of Science: Biochemistry

University of Zurich, Switzerland, 2017 - 2019

Exchange Year:

Swiss European Mobility Programme (SEMP)

University College Dublin, Ireland, 2016 - 2017

Bachelor of Science: Biology University of Zurich, Switzerland, 2014 - 2017

**What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?**

Growing up in Switzerland, I was privileged to enjoy a very good education from a young age on. My parents, a teacher and a judge, and my godparents, a veterinary and a physician, taught me that if you are willing to work hard you can reach your goals for your future life. It was never about a well-paid job for me, it was rather about the perspective of a profession I could conduct with passion. So, I always studied hard, but how little did I know about the world with my young age and my narrow view - I did not realize back then that what they taught me, although true for me, was not the reality for everyone. In 2012, I travelled to Botswana and only then I saw the full extent of educational inequality with my own eyes that I have only heard about before. Certainly, there were smarter and more ambitious kids there than myself but they simply lacked the opportunities, I had, to achieve their dreams. I am applying to this program hoping to be part of changing the perspectives of at least some kids by improving their education and thereby giving them new opportunities.

**In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.**

I truly love exploring new countries, stepping out of the bubble we live in in Switzerland. I was lucky enough to get to spend three months travelling through Borneo, Sulawesi and West Papua with my partner. I never travel with too many expectations, I am more interested in appreciating all the small details a foreign country has to offer me and learning from the people living in it. My partner and I often discussed how we do not only want to travel anymore, but rather like to give something back to the countries we are visiting, making a small change for the people living there. This wish became most prominent after visiting Malawi last fall. One day, walking through a small fisher's village some kids showed up and started talking to us. Suddenly a boy took his English exam out of his pocket and kindly asked us if we could help him. We started a small English class right there out on the street and we tried to give our best to teach these kids who were so eager to learn. I would have loved to stay there but unfortunately I had to get back home to my job.

**Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.**

In science education

Other

**Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.**

As a PhD student at the beginning of my 4th year, in the middle of the process of writing my thesis, I get the same question over and over again from family members, friends, colleagues and now here during this application process: "What do you want to do after finishing your PhD? - Do you want to go to industry or stay in academia?" Most of them ask this question as there would only be these two choices, as these would be the only two logical

career ways to proceed with - but my honest answer: “Neither.” So I am glad to have an additional option here. I see myself in a position where I can use my science education to increase medical access by developing cost-efficient tests and tools for patients or contribute to an improved education for kids in less developed countries. Alternatively, I would like to dedicate my work to wildlife conservation. Therefore, I see myself working for a non-profit organization, most likely not in Switzerland for the next few years, although I do not know yet where exactly my path will lead me in the long-term.

**CV/Resume**

 [230412 CV Sarah Busslinger.pdf](#)

**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

University email list

**Any other comments/questions?**

I would be happy to work at any of the sites the program is currently located (Philippines, Morocco, Bangladesh, or India).

I am also highly interested in helping to develop new site partnerships, and would consider to work there also longer than 6 months, as intended for the internships.

As I finish my PhD in September, my earliest starting date would be October 2023.

I would be looking very much forward to join Science Corps and hope to get in contact with you.

[Science Corps](#)